

Pharmacy Terminology Glossary

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Purpose

A reference glossary of common terms used across pharmacy screens, workflows, and documentation.

Terms

Term	Definition
Five Rights	The five checks (patient, medication, dose, route, time) performed before administering a medication.
Formulary	The list of medications approved for use within an institution.
High-Alert Medication	A medication with heightened risk of significant harm if used in error.
Route	The path by which a medication is administered, such as oral, intravenous, or intramuscular.
Titration	Gradual adjustment of a medication dose to reach a desired effect.
Adverse Drug Reaction	An unwanted or harmful reaction following administration of a medication.
Reconciliation	The process of comparing a patient's current medication list against new orders.
PRN	A medication order to be given as needed rather than on a fixed schedule.
Barcode Medication Administration	A verification method using barcode scanning to match patient and medication.
Polypharmacy	The concurrent use of multiple medications by a single patient.
Contraindication	A condition that makes a particular medication inadvisable for a specific patient.
Therapeutic Window	The dose range between a medication's minimum effective dose and its toxic dose.
Verification	Pharmacist review and approval of a medication order prior to dispensing.
Dispensing	The process of preparing and providing a medication for administration.
Anaphylaxis	A severe, potentially life-threatening allergic reaction.

Reference Visual (Synthetic)

SYNTHETIC MEDICATION LABEL — fabricated for OCR testing

Medication: Synthavir 50mg Tablet

Patient: SYN-1000 DOB: 2000-01-01

Dose: 1 tablet Route: Oral Frequency: BID

Lot: SYN-LOT-4471 Exp: 2027-06-30

Barcode: ||| || |||| | || |||